



CITY OF CAMBRIDGE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT AND UNIVERSITY RELATIONS COMMITTEE

AGENDA • APRIL 30, 2026

Regular Meeting

Sullivan Chamber

1:30 PM

Cambridge City Hall, 795 Massachusetts Ave, Cambridge, MA 02139

Published April 21, 2026 9:14 AM

Republished April 23, 2026 3:17 PM

Republished April 30, 2026 1:25 PM

Updated Call of meeting.

The Economic Development and University Relations Committee and Finance Committee will hold a joint public hearing with Harvard University to discuss and receive an update on the Harvard University Payment in Lieu of Taxes (PILOT) agreement.

I. ROLL CALL

II. COMMUNICATIONS

1. A presentation has been received from Thomas J. Lucey Senior Director of Government & Community Relations Harvard Public Affairs & Communications entitled "Harvard in Community".

III. ADJOURNMENT



City of Cambridge

COM 2026-20
FIRST IN COUNCIL
April 30, 2026

A presentation has been received from Thomas J. Lucey Senior Director of Government & Community Relations Harvard Public Affairs & Communications entitled "Harvard in Community".

A true copy;

ATTEST:-

A handwritten signature in cursive script, reading "Paula M. Crane".

Paula M. Crane,
Interim City Clerk



City of Cambridge

A presentation has been received from Thomas J. Lucey Senior Director of Government & Community Relations Harvard Public Affairs & Communications entitled "Harvard in Community".

Harvard in the Community

Economic Development and University Relations Committee & Finance
Committee

April 30, 2026



HARVARD
UNIVERSITY

Harvard in the Community



Key Areas of Harvard Engagement

- Partnerships with Cambridge Public Schools
- Community Engagement
- Supporting Cambridge-Based Initiatives
- Housing Support for Cambridge Residents
- Access to Harvard Institutions & Programming



Partnering with Cambridge Public Schools



- Harvard's educational programs are **available in every CPS school for all CPS grade levels and interests**
- Programs range from **internships to curriculum-based programming**
- **CPS educators can access free professional development workshops & academic coursework**
- Family Engagement and Parent Workshops

Cambridge Students Accepted to Harvard

- **23 students** from Cambridge were accepted to Harvard College last year.
- **120** have been accepted over the last 5 years



Partnering with Cambridge Public Schools



CURRICULUM SUPPORT

Building College Awareness:

- **All CPS 7th Graders** participate in **Project TEACH** and visit campus for a day of workshops and activities led by Harvard College students.
- **Harvard Education Day** is a partnership with Harvard Athletics that brings **CPS 6th graders** to campus to meet student athletes and experience campus life.
- As part of **Evolution Day**, **45 CRLS** students toured labs and meet with scientists to learn about their work and possible STEM career paths
- The **Emerging Scientists Program** connects CRLS students with Harvard researchers to provide meaningful and accessible research experiences in the life sciences



Partnering with Cambridge Public Schools



Internship & Mentorship Programs:

- The **Summer Youth Employment Program** provides students with valuable work experience, helping them develop positive work habits, gain professional experience, and increase their motivation to further their education and pursue career options.
- The **Science Research Mentoring Program (SRMP)** provides an opportunity for high school students to work on a year long independent research project in astrophysics under the guidance of a Harvard or MIT scientist.

Leadership & Fellowship Programs:

- The **Radcliffe Emerging Leaders Program** is a youth leadership development program that connects CRLS sophomores with Harvard undergraduates for year-long mentoring.
- The **James Bryant Conant Fellowship fund** supports the professional growth of outstanding teachers and administrators from Cambridge and Boston Public Schools who are accepted to Harvard Graduate School of Education (HGSE) degree programs.
- **Harvard Business School's Leadership Fellows program** offers nonprofit and public sector organizations the opportunity to leverage the experience, expertise, and skills of Harvard's MBA students for one year with a salary subsidized by the Harvard Business School



Partnering with Cambridge Public Schools



- The **Cambridge Harvard Summer Academy** is funded by Harvard University and takes place every summer at CRLS, aiming to help bridge the achievement gap for students who require academic intervention throughout the summer months.
- **Crimson Summer Academy** provides traditionally underserved high school students with a mix of classes, projects, and cultural activities on Harvard's campus.
 - **94%** of Crimson Summer Academy graduates complete college in 4 years.
 - **36** Cambridge students participated in the 2024-2025 academic year.
- The **Design Discovery Program** was developed by Harvard Graduate School of Design students and introduces high school students to architectural design, urban planning, graphic, industrial, and fine arts design and helps to put students on track for exploring these ideas at the collegiate level.



Supporting Key City Goals & Initiatives



Long-Term Partnership with Food for Free

- Address food insecurity
- **2000+** meals distributed weekly
- **12K+** pounds of food donated in FY25

Pro bono legal services for Cambridge residents

- Open to all Cambridge residents, the Clinical and Pro Bono programs provide thousands of hours of free legal services annually to Cambridge residents.



Supporting City Initiatives & Residents



Economic Inclusion

- Harvard's **Workforce Development Program** offers innovative and market-driven skills-based programs, workshops, and events that support **Cambridge residents** in their professional and career goals.
- Harvard is proud of its ongoing partnership with organized labor to support career development for next generation tradespeople
- Committed to the success of Harvard Square through intentional leasing of properties to small businesses, most of which are locally-owned and offer unique retail and dining options
- Focused on fostering a vibrant and pedestrian friendly retail environment throughout the Square



Supporting City Initiatives & Residents



- Harvard has implemented over \$10M in public realm and infrastructure improvements throughout Harvard Square.
- Harvard manages and maintains five acres of public open space at JFK Memorial Park.
- Harvard provides City projects with rent free parking and land for material storage, saving the City millions of dollars on capital projects.
- During winter storm events, Harvard creates a snow farm for the City to remove and store snow to ensure safety for Cambridge pedestrians and bicyclists.
- Harvard provides free parking for Cambridge residents during snow emergencies.



Housing Support for Cambridge Residents



Housing Support for Cambridge Residents

- Long-standing collaboration with Cambridge Housing Authority
- Harvard Local Housing Collaborative has helped enable over \$1 billion in affordable housing development throughout the area

Housing for Harvard Students & Affiliates

- **99% of undergraduates** live in dorms on campus
- **~500 bed** Harvard University Housing development under construction in Allston
- Strategic interventions to create graduate student housing in Cambridge by converting properties to residential uses.
- **30+ new beds** developed for University Affiliates in Cambridge

Harvard's Housing Partnerships in Allston

- The first Phase of the ERC is complete and includes **345 new units** of housing, **25% of which are affordable housing** units.
- Harvard has worked with the City of Boston and local partners to enable the creation of **1,300+ new units** of housing in Allston, with **over 300** of these units being **affordable**.



Access to Harvard Institutions & Programming



Museum Access

Harvard Museums are free to Cambridge residents

Access to Performing & Visual Arts on Campus

ArtsFest

- This four-day celebration in Harvard Square welcomes the wider community to experience the many arts at the heart of Harvard's diverse, creative community of students, faculty, staff, affiliates and alumni.

Arts Thursdays

- The University regularly opens its doors to the wider community for free performances, exhibitions and lectures on Thursday nights.



Local Impact & Spending



Local Jobs

- Harvard has been the **largest employer** in Cambridge for 25 consecutive years
- **4,413** Cambridge residents directly employed by Harvard
- **\$517M** in wages, salaries, and benefits paid to Cambridge residents in FY25

Anchoring the Knowledge-Based Economy in Cambridge

- **\$9.2M** paid for city services (water, sewer, other permit fees) in 2025
- **\$212M** spent in construction, supplies, and services in Cambridge in FY25

Attracting Tourism

- As a cultural anchor, Harvard's historic campus and world-class museums draw visitors from around the world.
- Harvard is one of the most visited tourist destinations in Massachusetts.
 - **650K+** visitors to Harvard Museums each year
 - **30K+** people come to Harvard Square to attend the University's Commencement each year

Resources for Additional Information

HARVARD IN THE COMMUNITY

www.community.harvard.edu

SUSTAINABILITY

Office for Sustainability

www.green.harvard.edu

PLANNING

Harvard University Planning and Design

www.hupad.harvard.edu

Construction Mitigation

www.construction.harvard.edu



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